



Hungry for goals: Harry Kane (left) leads the goal-scoring charts in Bundesliga, with 14 goals and seven assists in 13 matches. REUTERS

leagues, would be streamed for free on its own platform.

However, just as in 2021, the proposed idea was quickly shut down. The European Leagues issued a statement saying that, despite A22's claims, they had not been consulted about the relaunch, describing the model as "unrequested and unsubstantiated" and warning that it would increase the number of international matches in an already congested calendar.

Eyes on the prize for Kane

In search of an elusive trophy, Bayern Munich striker Harry Kane has been tearing it up in the Bundesliga, with 14 goals and seven assists in his 13 appearances.

Despite being sidelined for three weeks at the start of December due to injury, the England captain leads the goal-scoring charts in the league, closely followed by Eintracht Frankfurt's Omar Marmoush, who has 13 goals.

His presence on the pitch was sorely missed as Bayern succumbed to its first league defeat of the season against FSV Mainz 05. Furthermore, a 10-man Bayern side was knocked out of the DFB-Pokal Round of 16 by Bayer Leverkusen, which edged out a 1-0 victory.

Nevertheless, Bayern tops the league standings with a four-point gap over second-placed Leverkusen. With Kane making his return in Bayern's 5-1 thrashing of RB Leipzig, the Bavarians will be cautiously optimistic about their chances of holding onto the lead and handing Kane his first major title.

David de Gea's resurgence fuels Fiorentina

Fiorentina has emerged as an early challenger for the Serie A title, sitting fifth after 17 games and nine points behind leader Atalanta, which has played a game more. Much of its success this season can be attributed to the addition of Spaniard David de Gea (left) between the sticks.

Returning from his one-year hiatus after leaving Manchester United, the 34-year-old seems sharper than ever, keeping six clean sheets in his 14 league appearances this season.

Despite spending the first three games of the season on the bench, De Gea is well on his way to surpassing Pietro Terracciano's tally of eight clean sheets from last season. He is also second only to Genoa's Nicola Leali in terms of save percentage in the league, with 78.6 compared to Leali's 79.2.

While lifting the Scudetto seems improbable, the veteran custodian could play a massive role in leading Fiorentina to a top-four finish and ensuring its return to Champions League football for the first time since 2009-10.



REUTERS